

The PHRASE

There are four lines of words in the verse of EVENING SONG, and the music for each line of words is called a *phrase*. The musical phrase is marked by a slur:

Notes under the slur are played connectedly...singingly. Phrasing is really punctuation in music, and there is a slight "break" at the end of the phrase, just as there usually is at the end of a line of poetry. This slight break gives *meaning* to the music, as it also gives sense to the words of a poem. Begin to *think and play* a phrase at a time, so that your playing will have meaning.



9. Evening Song



Now the sil - ver star of eve - ning, Ush - ers in the stars of night;

One by one, their small lamps twink - ling, Fill the sky with ra - diant light.